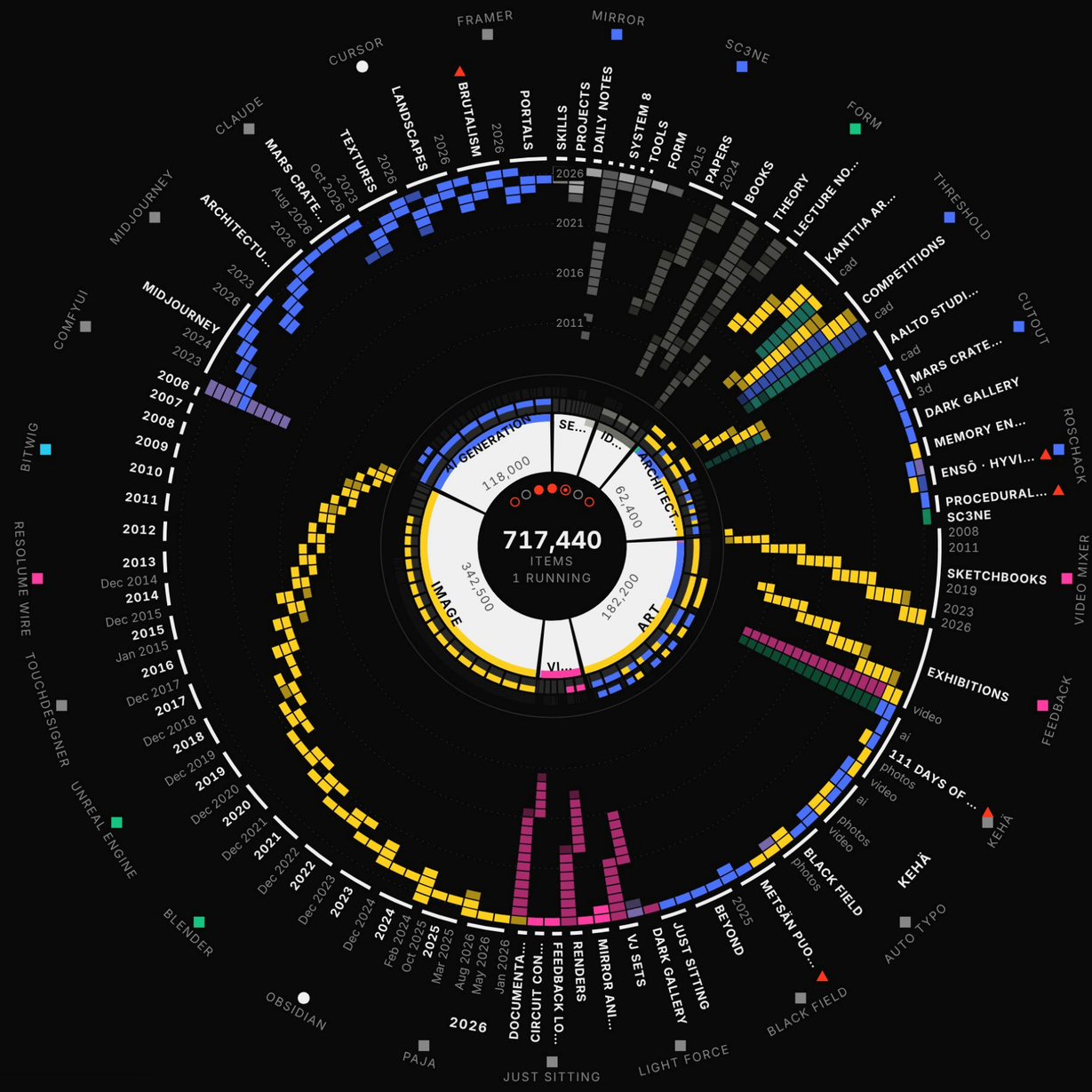
HOW THE INTERFACE WORKS

Control Room

One archive. One radial grammar. A fractal zoom from everything you have made down to a single file — and the tools to act on it.

717,440	1	4	5
FILES IN THE SAMPLE	CIRCLE FOR ALL OF IT	LENSES AT MOST	ROOMS

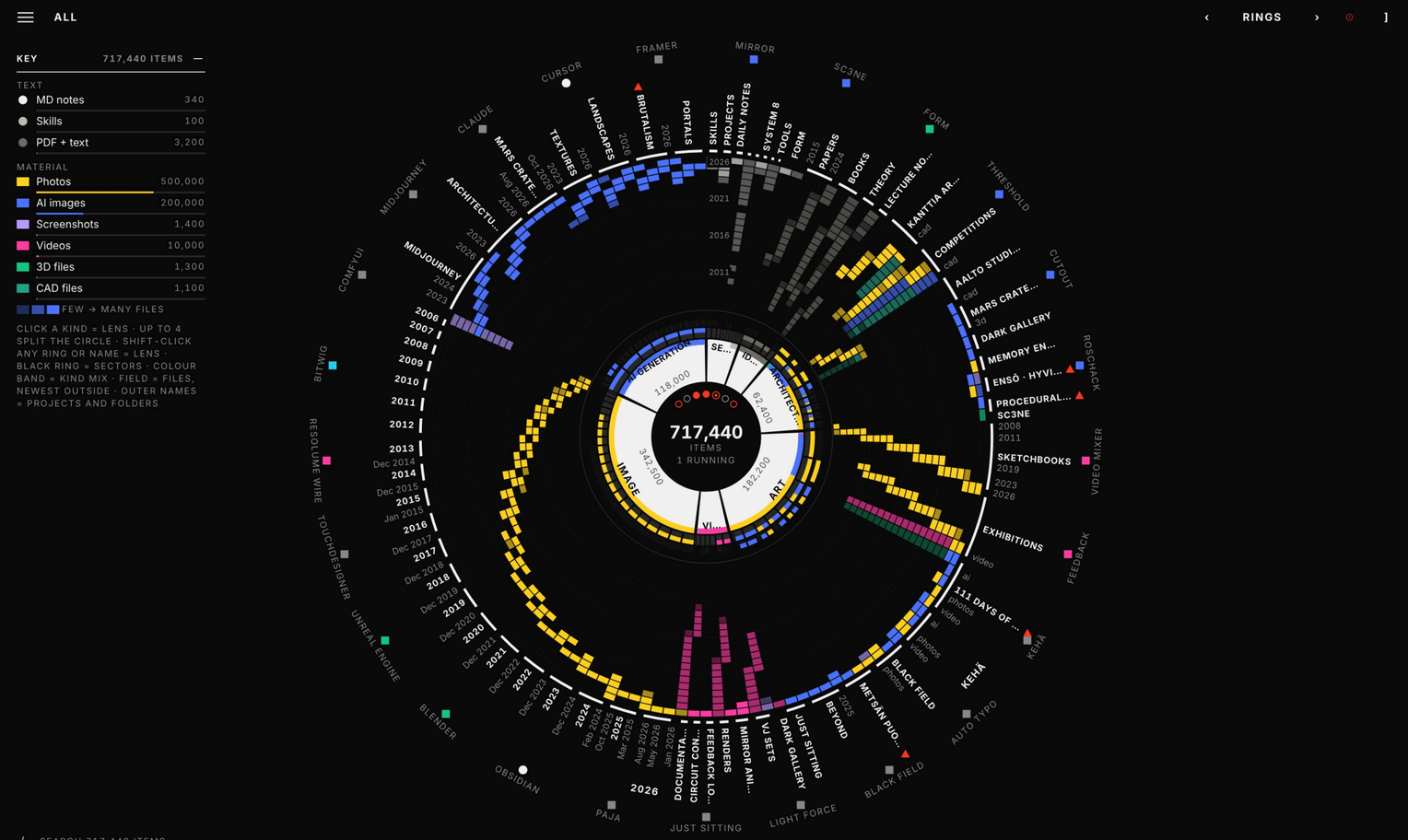


01 · ONE PICTURE OF EVERYTHING

Every file you have, in one circle.

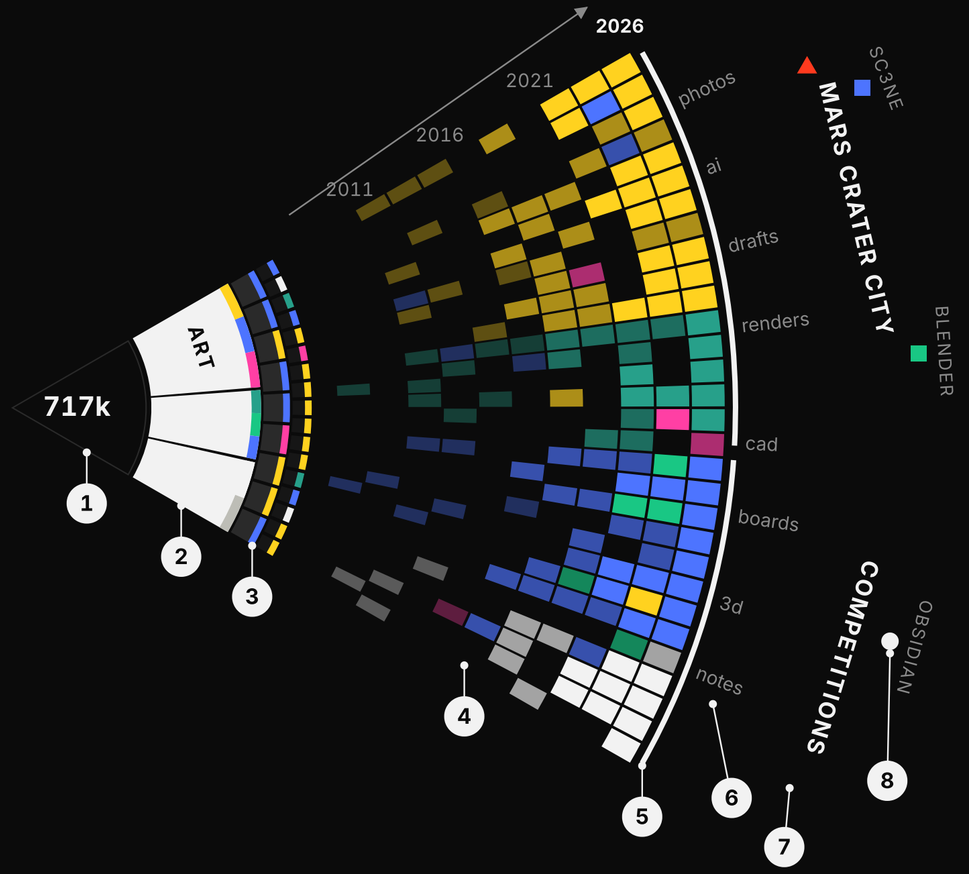
Notes, books, photos, AI images, screenshots, video, 3D and CAD — indexed by a small bridge on your computer and drawn as rings. Nothing to scroll through: you zoom.

1	**Centre**	what you are looking at, and how many files
2	**Black ring**	what it splits into — sectors at the top level
3	**Thin rings**	what those hold; the colour band = their mix of kinds
4	**Field**	the files themselves, newest at the outer edge
5	**Outer ring**	projects in bold, folders in small type
6	**Orbit**	your tools



02 · ANATOMY

A section through the rings.



1	**Centre**	the focus: its name and how many files
2	**Black ring**	the first split — at the top: sectors
3	**Thin rings**	the next two splits; a colour strip shows each segment's mix of kinds
4	**Field**	one block per angle × time; colour = the kind that dominates, strength = few → many files; time runs outward to this year
5	**Project rule**	a black line over each project's stretch
6	**Folder names**	small, reading outward
7	**Project names**	bold along the circle; a red ▲ when something needs you
8	**Tools**	the orbit: square colour = what each tool takes

03 · GRAMMAR

Colour says what a file is. Shape backs it up.

TEXT · GREYS · CIRCLES

MD notes	340
Skills	100
Code	
PDF + text	3,200

Text is quiet, so material stands out — and the circle keeps the greys apart from the grey rings.

MATERIAL · STRONG COLOUR · SQUARES

Photos	500,000
AI images	200,000
Screenshots	1,400
Videos	10,000
Audio	
3D files	1,300
CAD files	1,100

STATE · RED-ORANGE ONLY

Focus · running · needs you

Red-orange never stands for a kind. If you see it, something is selected, running or waiting for you.

STRENGTH · FEW → MANY FILES



FLAT

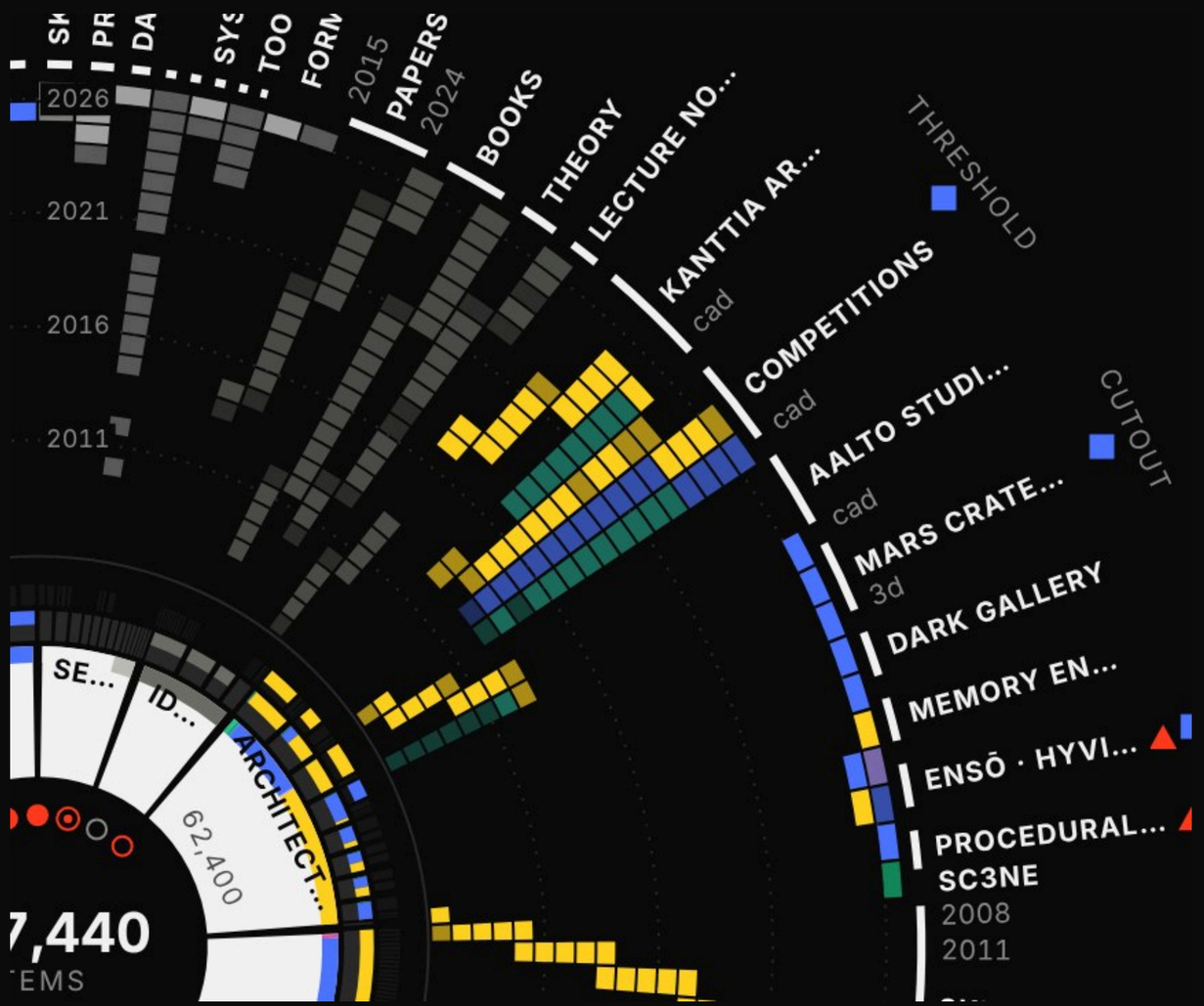
No gradients, no shadows, square corners. Outlines appear only to mark a state.

04 · TIME RUNS OUTWARD

This year sits at the outer edge.

The outer edge is where the ring is longest. Most of an archive is recent, so the newest material gets the most room — and it sits right next to the names of the projects and folders it belongs to.

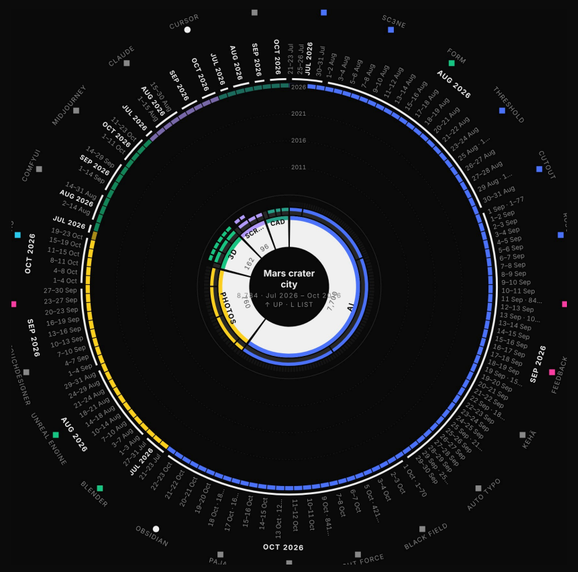
Older years step inward toward the centre. The dotted circles are year guides; their labels run up the top of the field.

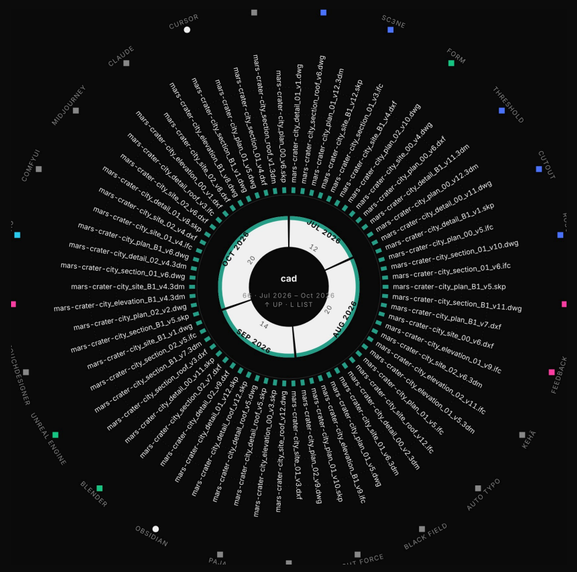


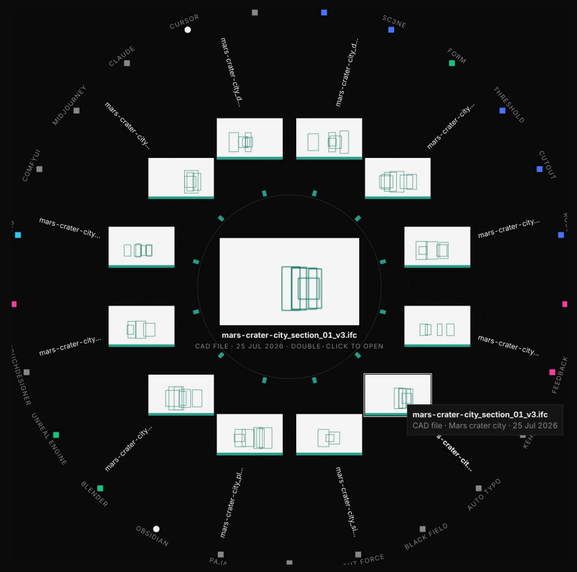
05 · ONE GRAMMAR AT EVERY LEVEL

Zoom in, and the same picture repeats.









SECTOR

AI generation: its projects become the black ring

PROJECT

Architecture › Mars crater city

NAMES

enough room per file: names read outward

THUMBNAILS

hover for a large preview in the centre

---

under ~2 px per file

blocks

~2–6 px

spokes

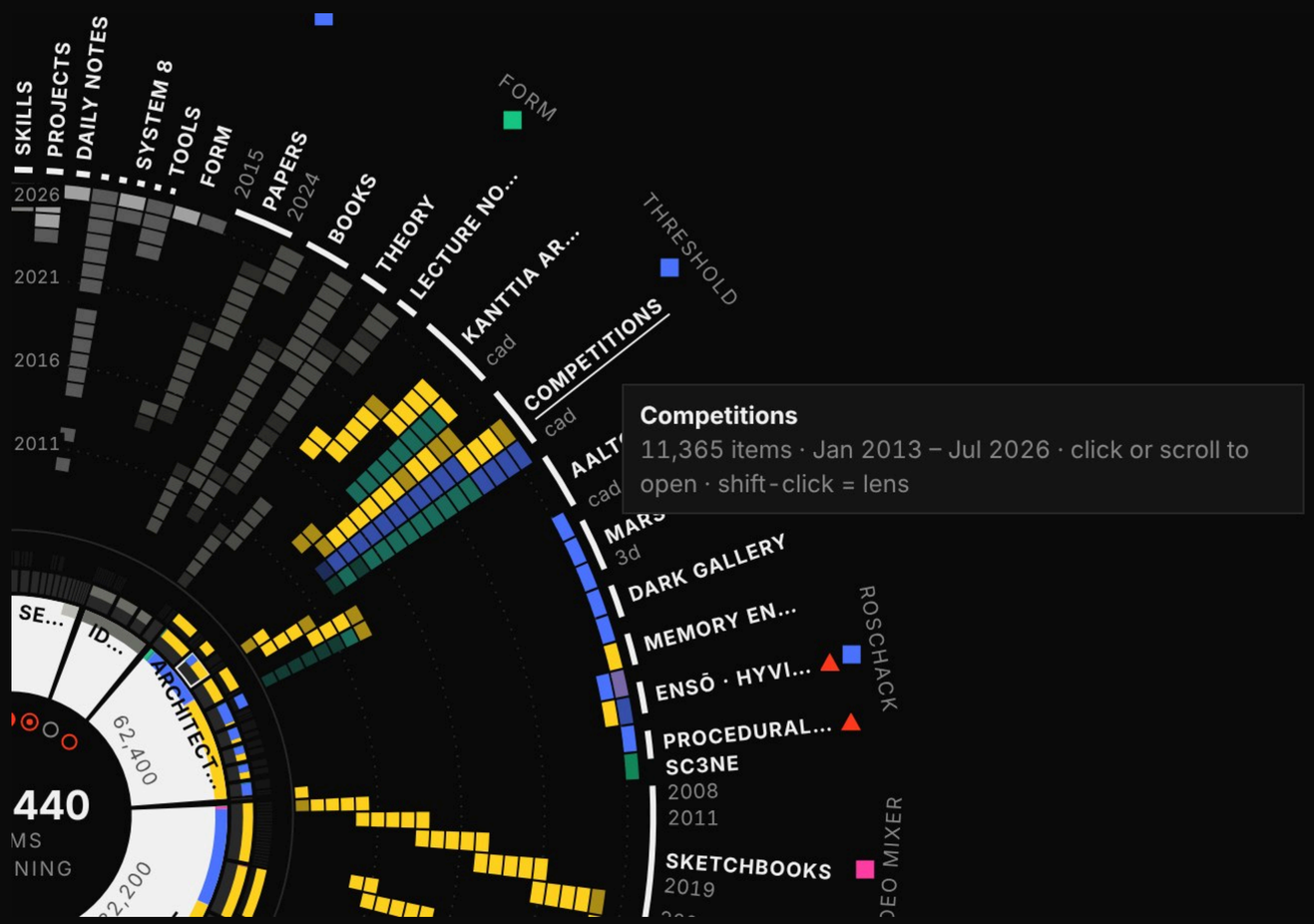
~6–28 px

file names

28 px +

thumbnails

Scroll over a ring to zoom into it · scroll out or click the centre to go up · drag to turn · double-click a file to open it · L lists the focus



06 · NAMES YOU CAN CLICK

Projects and folders, named where there is room.

A **black rule** marks each project's stretch of the ring.

PROJECT NAMES in bold run along the circle. A project too narrow for that gets its name in bold reading outward instead.

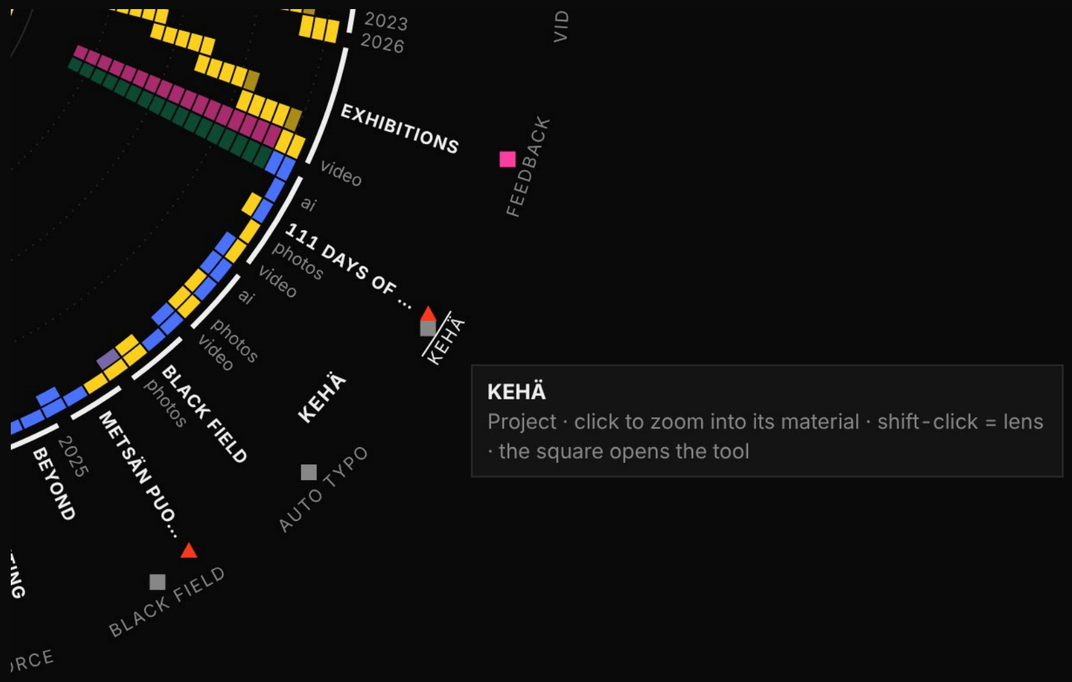
folder names in small type read outward.

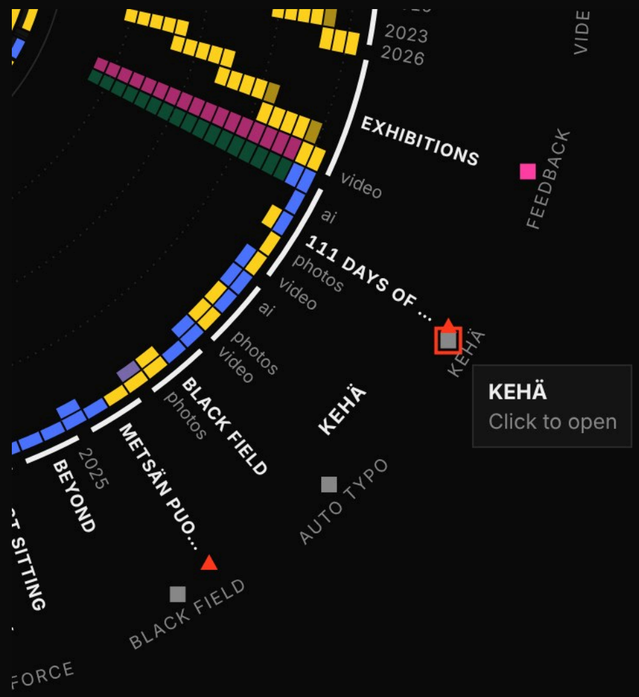
Click a name to zoom in. **Shift-click** to open it as a lens.

Zoom down to file names and the ring fades — the file names take its place.

07 · THE ORBIT

Your tools circle everything.





THE NAME

is the project, when one exists — KEHÄ the tool is also KEHÄ the project. Click: zoom into its code, plans and renders.

THE SQUARE

opens the tool — with the selected file, if it fits. A red-orange outline means it fits.

takes images · video · 3D · launch only · takes text

08 · SPLIT THE CIRCLE

A lens is a filter with its own rings.





TWO LENSES

CAD files · Competitions — two halves

FOUR LENSES

+ Photos · MD notes — four quarters

Click a kind

in the key, top left

Type and press Enter

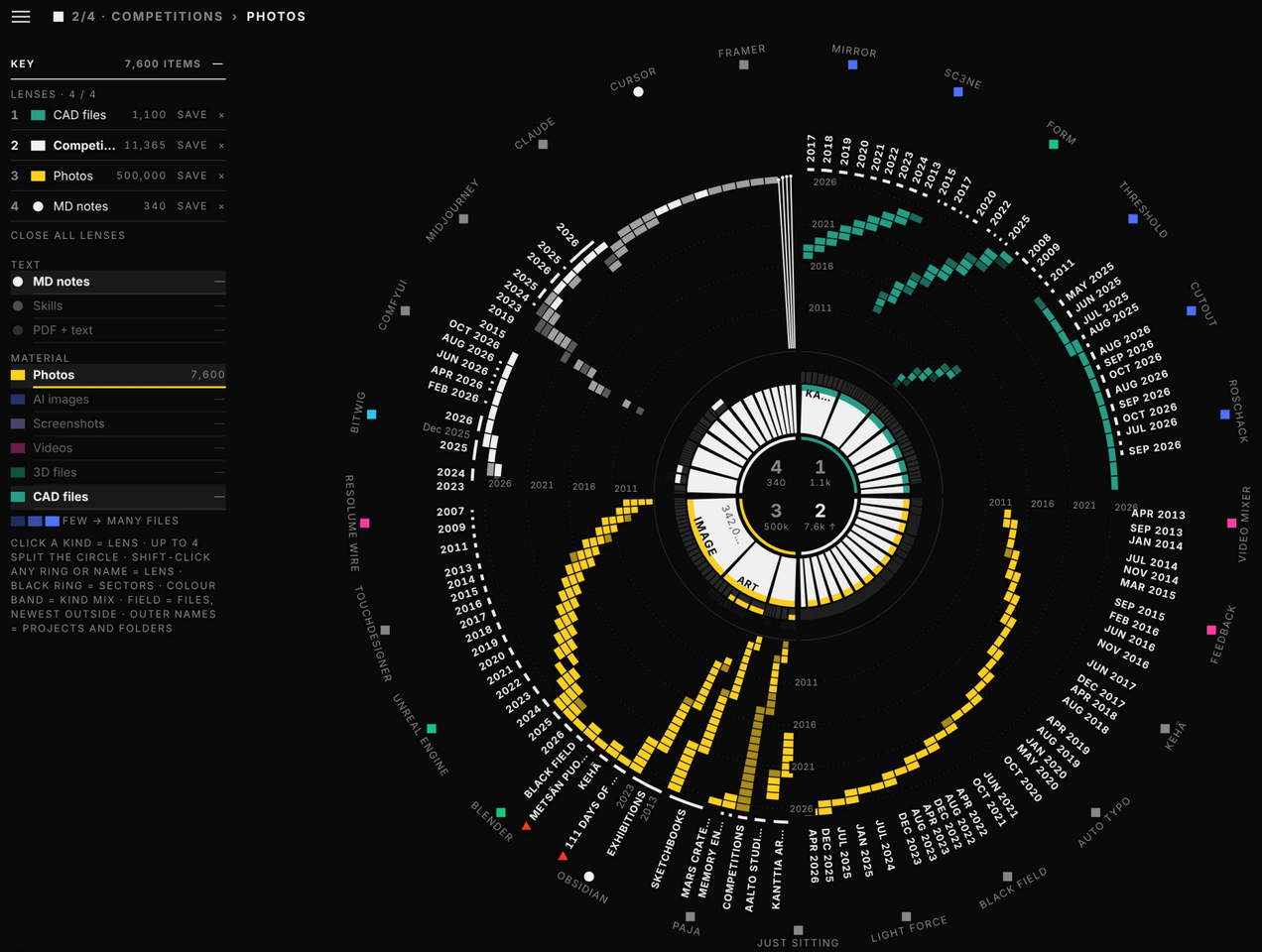
work:"competitions" · kind:photo museum · in:architecture year:2019-2023

Shift-click

any ring or name

Open as lens

right panel

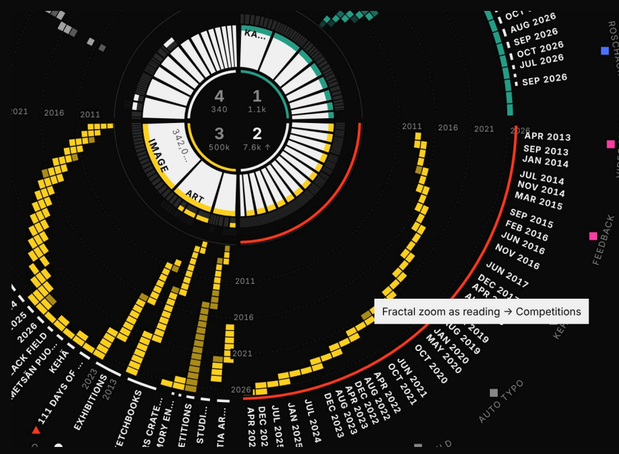


09 · EACH SLICE ON ITS OWN

Four slices, four depths.

Scroll over a slice and only that one zooms. Here slice 2 has gone into Competitions › photos while the others stay where they were.

The centre numbers the slices. The key lists the lenses with the same numbers; the trail shows where the active slice is.



Drag a file from one slice onto another to add it there.

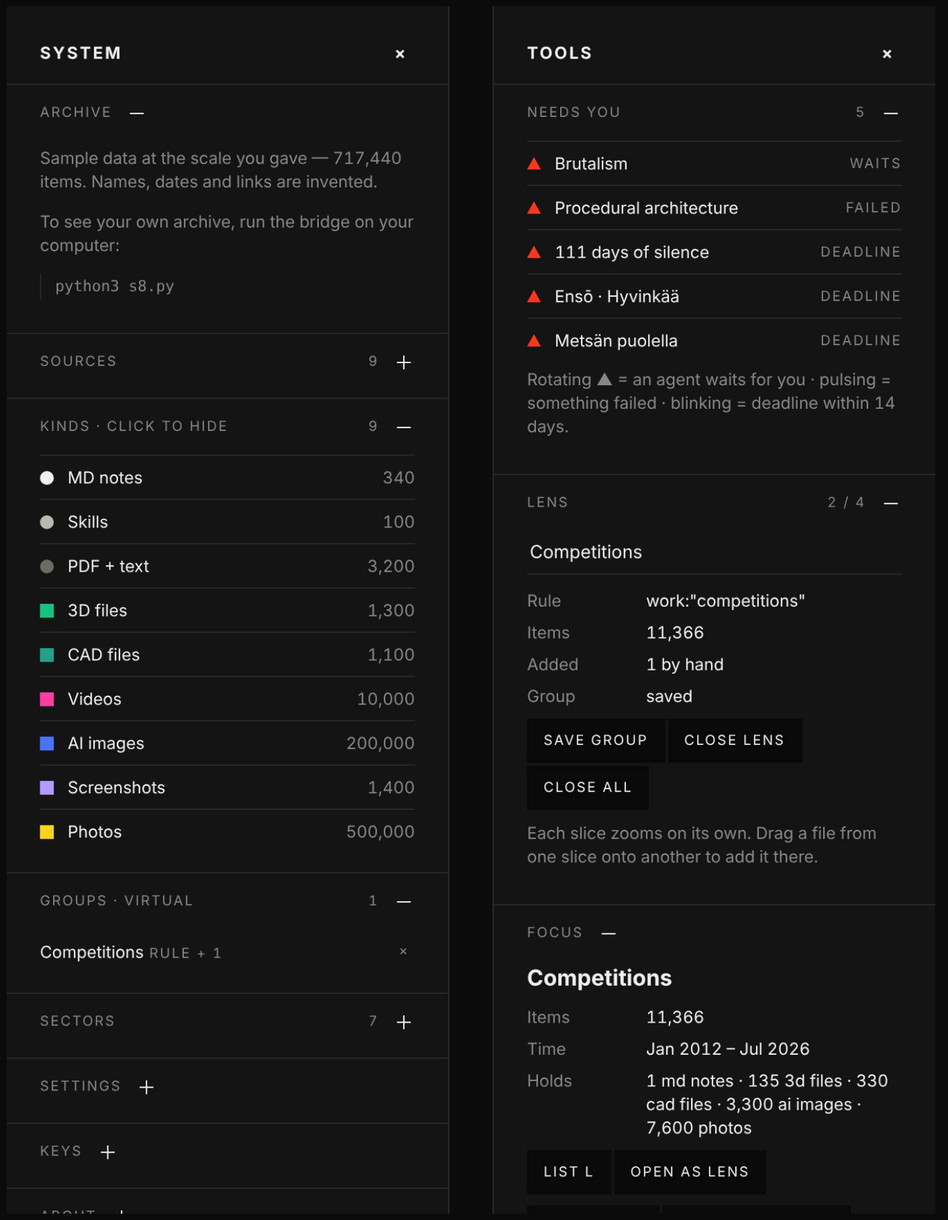
10 · VIRTUAL GROUPS

Save a lens, keep a group.

A group is a lens you keep: its rule, plus the files you dragged into it by hand. Open it again from the left panel and it comes back as a slice.

Nothing is copied or moved on disk. With the bridge, each group is also written as a note in your vault — `_s8/groups` — listing its files, so Obsidian sees it too.

New group in the right panel starts an empty one to drag files into.



11 · RED TRIANGLES

How it moves says why.



Rotating
an agent waits for permission or information



Pulsing
something failed



Blinking
a deadline within 14 days

AN AGENT ASKS FOR YOU WITH ONE LINE

```
print('S8: needs your OK to overwrite the renders')
```

The task turns to waiting and the project named in its config gets a rotating ▲. A task you stop yourself is not a failure.

TOOLS ×

NEEDS YOU 5 —

- ▲ Brutalism — WAITS
- ▲ Procedural architecture — FAILED
- ▲ 111 days of silence — DEADLINE
- ▲ Ensō · Hyvinkää — DEADLINE
- ▲ Metsän puolella — DEADLINE

Rotating ▲ = an agent waits for you · pulsing = something failed · blinking = deadline within 14 days.

FOCUS —

111 days of silence

Items	30,650
Time	Sep 2025 – Oct 2026
Holds	200 3d files · 450 videos · 18,000 ai images · 12,000 photos

LIST L | UP | OPEN AS LENS

11/02/2026 SAVE CLEAR

Saved as “deadline:” at the top of the project’s note (Obsidian shows it under Properties). Within 14 days the project gets a blinking ▲ and a mark on the year grid.

NEW GROUP | NEW FOLDER HERE

A group is virtual — files stay where they are. A folder is real, made in Art/111 days of silence.

TOOLS 25 —

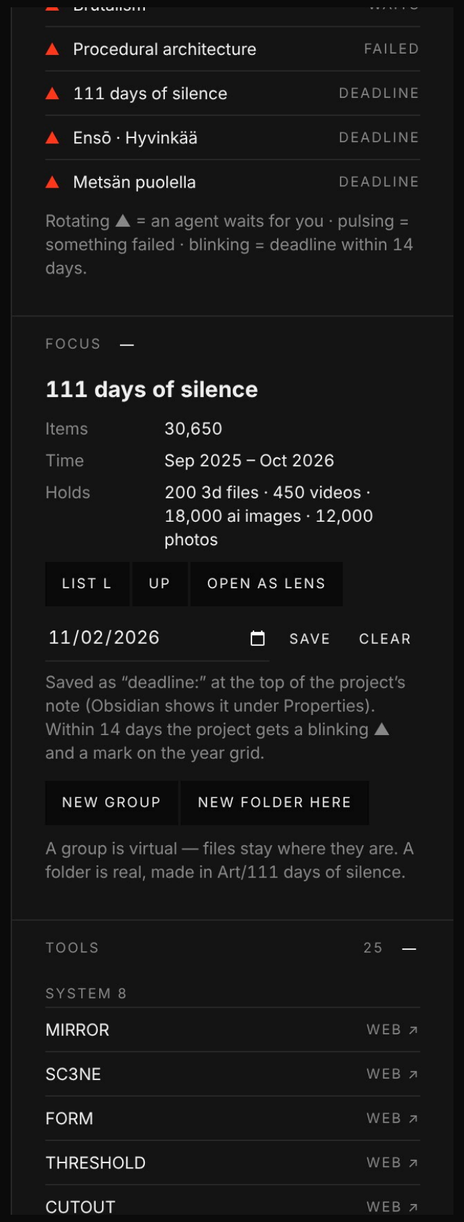
12 · DEADLINES

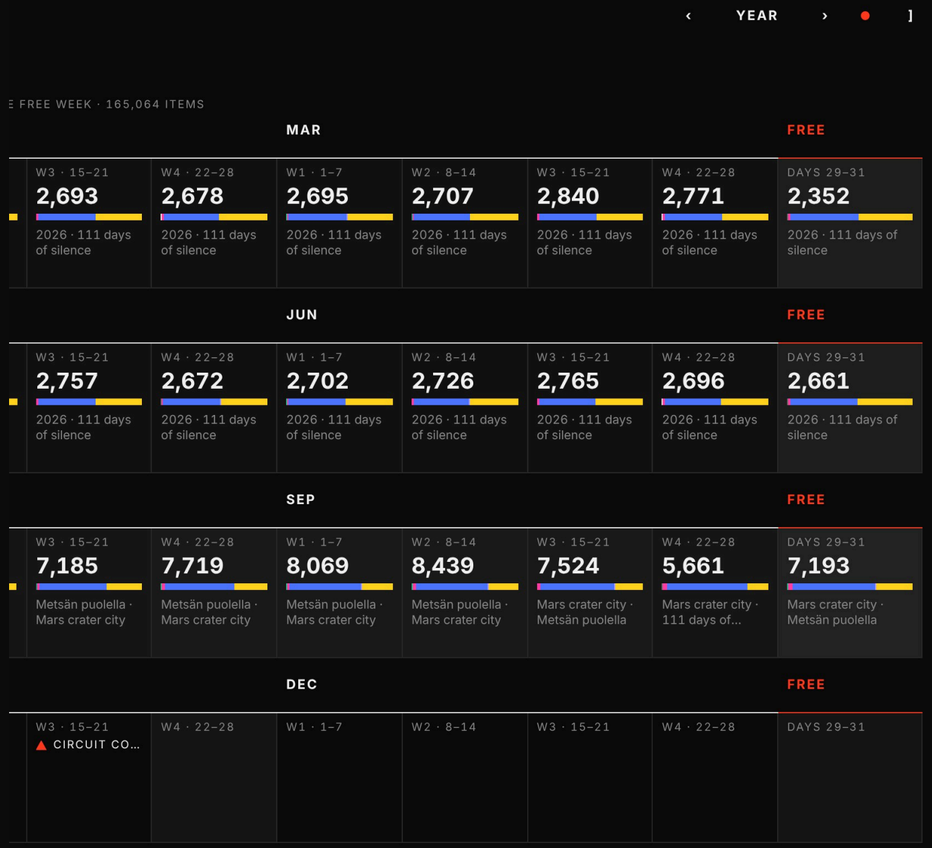
One line at the top of a note.

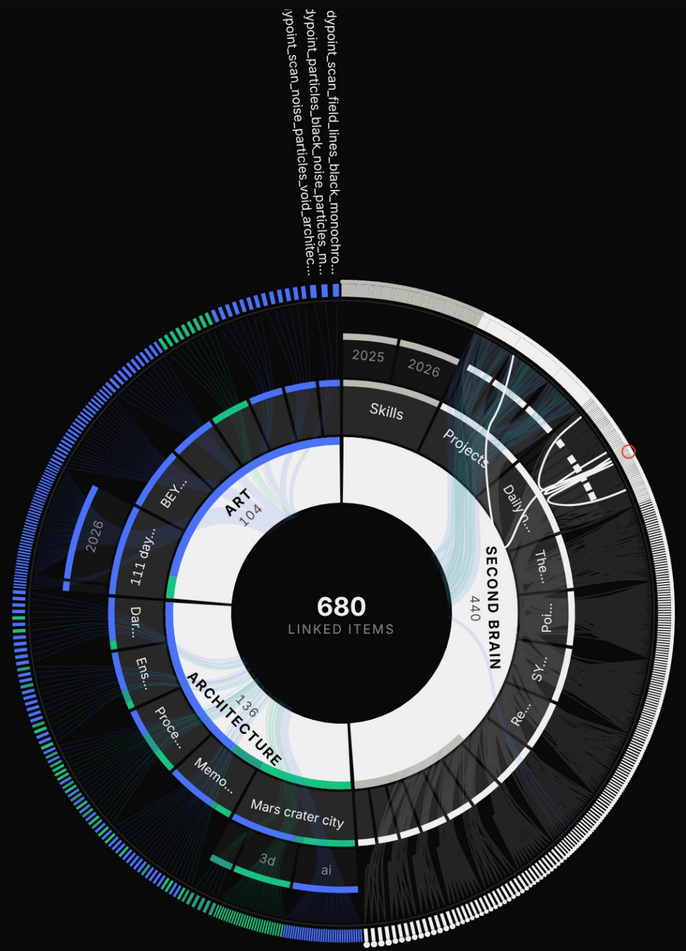
```
---
work: Mars crater city
deadline: 2026-11-15
---
```

Obsidian shows these lines as **Properties**. Or set the date in the right panel — the bridge writes the line for you.

Within 14 days the project blinks on the rings and is marked on the year grid.







13 · GRAPH

What links to what, on the same rings.

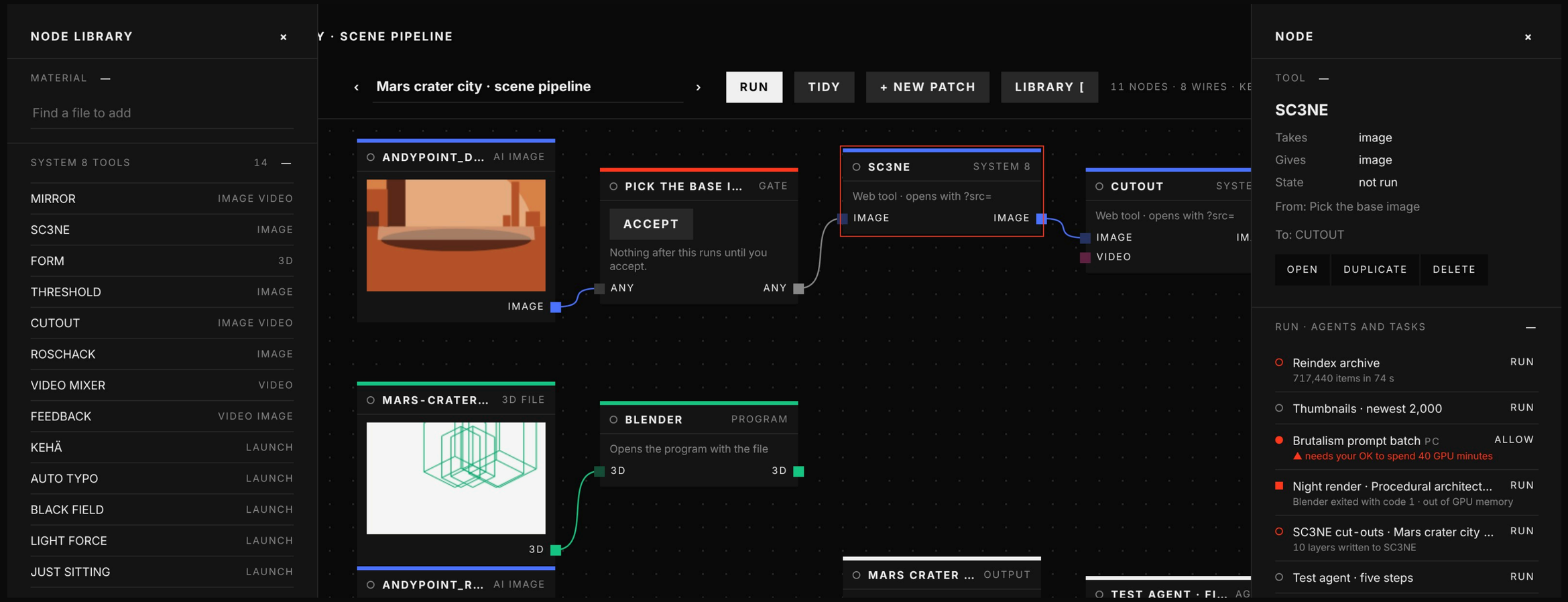
Notes, skills and everything they link to — wikilinks, embeds, sidecar notes, collections.

Links are bundled through the rings, so related notes share a path and nothing sits on top of anything else. Lines take the colour of the linked file.

Select a note to bring its links forward. Zoom exactly as in the rings.

14 · PATCH

Wire material into tools, agents and gates.



Typed ports
circle = text, square = material; pale = input on the left, solid = output on the right

Wrong wire
it says why, and what would fit between

Gate
nothing after it runs until you accept

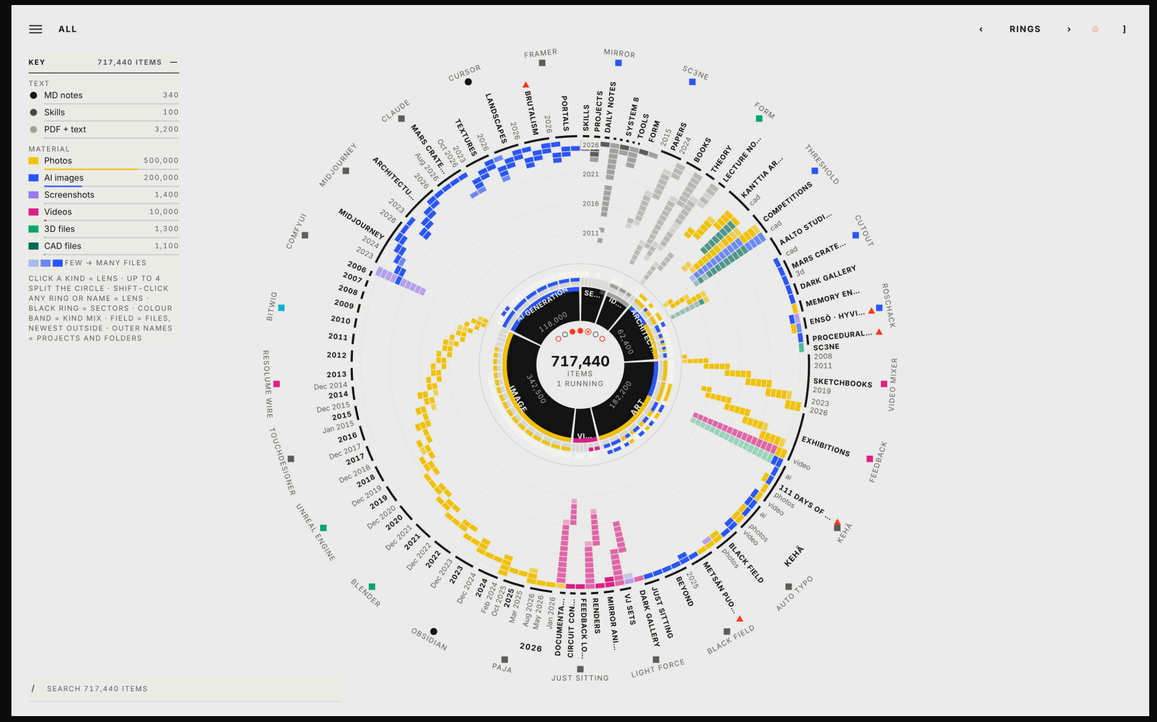
Run
follows the wires · Tidy lines nodes up · Duplicate

15 · DARK AND LIGHT

The same rings on either ground.



DARK the black ring turns light; colours step up to stay strong on black



LIGHT the original ground: #EDEDEB, ink #141414

Left panel → Settings → Ground: Light · Dark · System. Every colour is a variable at the top of style.css, set for both grounds.

16 · TWO PARTS

A bridge on your computer, a page in your browser.

Your folders
photos · Midjourney · vault · CAD · video

→

s8.py · the bridge
one Python file · indexes · thumbnails · tasks · notes

→

Control room
any browser · this computer or the iPad

Obsidian vault
sidecar notes · groups · project deadlines · collections in _s8/

Your tools
programs · app links · SYSTEM 8 web tools with ?src=

Agents
tasks you configure · S8: needs … when they need you

WHERE THINGS LIVE

`.s8/`
the index, parsed notes and prompts, thumbnails, patches, groups — delete any time, it is rebuilt

`vault/_s8/`
sidecar notes per file, group notes, project deadlines, collections — plain Markdown

`config.json`
your folders, sectors, vault, tools and tasks

Without the bridge the page runs on a built-in sample of 717,440 invented items. Every request needs the bridge's token; it listens only on this computer unless you open it to the iPad.

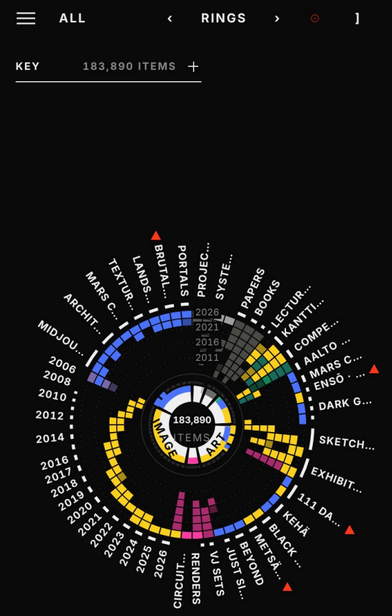
17 · KEYS

Quick reference.

/	search
Enter	the search becomes a lens · Shift+Enter: list
Scroll	zoom into the ring under the pointer · out: up
Drag	turn the rings · in lenses: carry a file to another slice
Shift-click	a ring or name becomes a lens
L	list everything in the focus
P	add the selection to the patch
O · R	open · reveal the selection
1 – 5	Rings · Graph · Patch · Year · Field
[ ]	left · right panel
Esc · ⌫	back · up one level

NOT YET

- Answering a waiting agent from the control room
- Tools that hand their result back to the patch
- Mac and PC bridges joined in one view
- Photo dates from EXIF · meaning-based search



/ SEARCH 183,890 ITEMS

Phone width: one column, panels slide over.

SYSTEM 8

Control room · build 1.3
Know → make → share.

